

# Rediscovering Your Identity

You may answer privately, in prayer, without writing everything down. Nothing here is graded or collected.

## 1 • Check-in

1. List the roles you hold: family, work, church, community. All of them, including the informal ones, like “the one who holds everyone together.” This is not asking you to erase your relational or vocational identity; “parent,” “pastor,” “friend,” and “neighbour” describe real relationships and responsibilities. The question is whether any one role has become the sole measure of your worth.

| Role | A little | Some | A great deal |
|------|----------|------|--------------|
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|      |          |      |              |
|      |          |      |              |
|      |          |      |              |

2. Beside each, mark honestly how much of your sense of worth rests on it. A little, some, or a great deal. (Tick a column beside each role.)

3. Which role, if it ended tomorrow, would leave you least sure who you are?

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4. If you could not mention achievements, productivity, income, influence, or how useful you are to others, what would you want someone to understand about you? Try to write two sentences.

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## 3 • Silence

Fifteen minutes, or the length you can manage. “See what love the Father has given us.” Or: “Abba, Father.” Or: “Nothing can separate me from the love of God in Christ.”

## 4 • Journal

1. What happened when you tried to be rather than do in the silence? Restlessness, relief, discomfort, blankness? Write it down.

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2. The tempter's challenge carried the implication, "Prove who you are on these terms." Where have you been trying to prove your worth through achievement, usefulness, visibility, or sacrifice?

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3. Which role could you hold with less fear or compulsion if you trusted that it was not the source of your worth? Is there any optional responsibility that may need to be reduced, delegated, or released?

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4. Is there a loss of role, past or approaching, that you have been treating as a loss of self? Name it.

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## **6 • Closing declaration**

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

*Before Jesus began his work, the Father called him beloved; through him, I am called God's child.*

*What I do rests on who I am, not the other way round.*

*My roles matter, and they are not the measure of my worth.*

*I am not a slave who must stay useful.*

*I am a child who is loved.*

## Three columns

The shaded rows are examples. Fill in your own roles below them. The third column is the work of the exercise: find it in Scripture, with the references; do not invent it.

| What I do | What matters about this role      | What remains true beyond this role                                     |
|-----------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pastor    | Teaching and caring for people    | I remain God's child and part of Christ's body when I am not preaching |
| Parent    | Loving and protecting my children | My worth is not measured by my children's choices                      |
| Provider  | Supporting my household           | Income and usefulness are not the price of God's love                  |
|           |                                   |                                                                        |
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Some to start from: Created in God's image (Genesis 1:27) · A child of God (1 John 3:1) · Loved by God while still a sinner; his love was not earned by my improvement (Romans 5:8) · Not condemned (Romans 8:1) · Adopted, not enslaved (Galatians 4:7) · Chosen in Christ for holiness (Ephesians 1:4) · A recipient of grace, not self-made (Ephesians 2:8–10) · Part of Christ's body, with gifts and limits (1 Corinthians 12:12–27) · Called to love God and neighbour (Matthew 22:37–39) · A work in progress under God's care (Philippians 1:6) · Not separated from God's love by anything (Romans 8:38–39) · Not left or forsaken by God (Hebrews 13:5)

**Card to cut out · keep it somewhere useful and private**

**What remains true** (three or four lines from the third column)

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